

Qik Video CConnect for iPhone

Skype competitor Qik released the Qik Video Connect for iPhone, which offers two way video calls and lets you record video mails

WebM for IE9

Google released the WebM video plugin for the Internet Explorer 9 to bring web video technology to the browser

Defence which will secure all the devices within your home network from any attack. The link scanner provides a status after every search result, telling you if the site is safe or has some threats lurking. The McAfee SiteAdvisor LIVE allows you to safely share links through Facebook or Twitter. The McAfee File Shredder lets you permanently delete sensitive files.

Net Protector 2011 has the option of scanning old Windows OS based mobile phones. You can also select areas not to scan. It has around eight utilities including Worm Trapper, Process checker, USB lock among others. You also get a circular gadget which has direct buttons to go directly to scan, reports, update and settings menus. There is no provision for parental control or data backup.

Kaspersky PURE has a unique technology called Safe Run also known as a Sandbox, which basically lets you run an application in a virtualised environment, providing better security. You can add applications to be run in the Sandbox. On enabling Parental control, Kaspersky starts blocking website by heuristic analysis even if you have not mentioned what categories to block by Configuring the parental control.

Avast consists of around eight real-time shields for file systems, mail, web, P2P, etc. An interesting addition to this version is Auto Sandboxing. This feature works like the one in Kaspersky PURE, but in Avast, programs are placed in a virtualised state, if Avast suspects any threats. This is done automatically, hence the name Auto-Sandboxing. You can also manually sandbox

programs or browser environments. Sandboxing allows the program to run, but its operations are being monitored by the suite. Any changes made to the file system or registry will only affect the virtual environment and not have any lasting effect on the actual system. A browser plug-in called WebRep reports the reputation of the current website and marks links in the search results based on its reputation rating. It works in IE and Firefox browsers. Moreover it offers a free standalone anti-virus program.

AVG scans URLs and gives you its safety status, but this works only with Internet Explorer. AVG incorporates an Alternate Data Stream scanner which helps in removing hidden malware. You can

we found somewhat gimmicky was the Activity Map which gives a ticker of the number of virus threats across the world.

In Panda, Parental control installation is quite easy. It has Kids, Teen, Employee, personalised and without filter modes. There are very limited customisation options. You can set a list of blocked websites.

eScan's dock interface is a quite easy to navigate through. The central portion of the interface shows the various tweaking options based on which menu you have selected from the top panel or the lower dock menu.

In the tweaking interface again, you have two demarcations namely Configuration and Reports. This makes using the suite quite easy even for a novice, as

overall. Navigating the user interface is quite intuitive.

The main home screen is neatly divided into self explanatory segments such as Backup and Restore, Computer Protection and Parental Control. There are direct buttons for virtual keyboard, data encryption, password manager and home network control under the three main tabs.

Performance

Norton 360 gave performance related alerts. For instance, when we were running CineBench R10, it indicated High CPU Usage. Trend Micro Titanium occupies about 26MB of memory in the idle state which was quite surprising. In Quick Heal installation we did run into some issues as the installer was trying to locate some file. We had to uninstall and reinstall to get it working. Quick Heal Total surprised us with a 181 MB memory usage on load whereas on idle it never crossed 4MB. This is a massive jump and hampers any applications that may be running while the system scan is on. For instance, the 100 MB VOB to DIVX conversion took 120 seconds while the AV scan was on, as opposed to just 67 secs without the scan running in the background. This is a huge difference which is not really desirable, considering the other security suites that we tested did not give so much of a difference.

In Avira we were shocked to see it taking 18 minutes to scan the 8GB assorted test folder. All other suites took under 2 mins to scan the same folder, except G Data. We tried re scanning the same folder after some time, and there was hardly any improvement in the scan speed. The memory



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get into detailed tweaking by clicking on each icon. There is a small gadget which has options to scan links from Twitter and Facebook as well. There is no parental control option on it. Like Avast, AVG also offers a free anti-virus solution.

Ease of Use

Navigating through Norton 360 is quite easy and the menu system is quite intuitive. It will require a minimal learning curve. The only thing

it does not overwhelm the user at the main interface level.

In Trend Micro Titanium Parental Control is quite easy to setup. You will have to submit an email ID and then it guides you through the various steps like Web filtering and Web access schedule. The categories in the Web filtering screen are pre-defined, and there is no way for you to filter the web by keyword search.

Kaspersky PURE looks the most pleasing after Norton 360. There is a greenish tinge